

Wonderla Holidays Ltd

Concall Tracker · Q1 FY2027 (quarter ended 30 June 2026) · NSE: WONDERLA · Report prepared 20 Aug 2026

Not investment advice. Do your own due diligence. An AI-generated reading of the company's earnings-call transcripts and filings.

1 Snapshot

Wonderla builds and runs five of its own amusement and water parks in India (Kochi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Bhubaneswar, Chennai) and earns money two ways: an entry ticket, and whatever the visitor spends inside on food, retail and two resorts. It designs and builds much of its own ride hardware in-house, so a Wonderla park costs a fraction of an imported one.

Item	Number	What it means in plain words
Market value of the company	₹3,109 cr at ₹490/share	Mid-cap. The whole company is worth about what five parks cost to build.
Sales, FY26 (year to Mar 2026)	₹519 cr	Up 7% in two years, from ₹483 cr in FY24. Almost flat despite two new parks.
Operating profit / margin, FY26	₹166 cr / 32%	Was ₹229 cr and 47% in FY24. Profit fell ₹63 cr while sales rose ₹36 cr.
Net profit, FY26	₹82 cr	Down 48% from ₹158 cr in FY24. Two extra parks, half the profit.
Return on capital employed (and on equity)	6.20% (ROE 4.60%)	For every ₹100 tied up in parks the business earns ₹6.20 a year before tax — less than a bank fixed deposit, and the shareholders' own money earns less than inflation. This is the single most important number in the report.
Debt	₹6 cr against ₹402 cr of investments	Effectively debt-free and cash-rich. The problem is not the balance sheet, it is the return on it.
Book value / P/E / dividend yield	₹283 / 29.4x / 0.41%	Priced at 1.7x the accounting value of its assets and 29x earnings — a growth price on a 6% return.
Latest quarter (Jun 2026)	Sales ₹243 cr (+45%), net profit ₹73 cr (+38%)	The best quarter ever reported. Section 3 tests how much of it repeats.

Read the quarters year-on-year, never one after the other. Summer holidays (Apr–Jun) are everything here. Operating margin by quarter runs **46% (Jun) → 9% (Sep) → 30% (Dec) → 30% (Mar)**, and the September 2025 quarter made a small net **loss of ₹2 cr** — that is normal, not a warning. CFO Saji Louiz, Feb 2026: *"Our Q1 is the strongest quarter and then followed by Q3 and then Q4. Q2 will be the weakest quarter."*

2 Concall coverage

Quarter	Call date	Transcript read?
Q1 FY27	05 Aug 2026	Yes — deep-read, full transcript (all 17 pages)
Q4 FY26 / FY26	08 May 2026	Yes — deep-read
Q3 FY26	05 Feb 2026	Yes — deep-read (Chennai launch call)
Q2 FY26	07 Nov 2025	Yes — deep-read
Q1 FY26	01 Aug 2025	Yes — deep-read (this is the base quarter for the +45%)
Q4 FY25 / FY25	08 May 2025	Yes — deep-read
Q4 FY24 / FY24	17 May 2024	Yes — targeted read of the FY25 guidance section
44 earlier calls, Feb 2016 – Feb 2025	Feb 2016 – Feb 2025	Keyword-searched, not read line by line, for park opening dates, footfall and ARPU guidance, margin targets, capex and payback. Passages then read in full where a promise was found — notably Jun 2019, Feb 2020, Nov 2023 and Feb 2024 on the Chennai timeline and budget.

Honest coverage note. Screener lists 58 calls; 51 transcripts were obtained and are the basis of this report. The seven missing (06, 07, 28, 38, 46, 47, 49) are all pre-Nov-2024 and all bracketed by adjacent calls, so no promise chain below rests on a missing document. Q1 FY27 is covered in full, and the ten-year promise record has been used.

Latest concall highlights — Q1 FY27 (call Aug 2026)

- **Record quarter, and Chennai is the reason.** Revenue ₹243 cr (+44% year-on-year), EBITDA ₹122 cr, net profit ₹72.8 cr, footfall **12.25 lakh, up 33%**. Chennai — open only since 2 December 2025 — alone did **₹45 cr of revenue and 2.42 lakh visitors in its first summer**. In plain words: the biggest reason this quarter looks so good is a park that did not exist a year ago.
- **The old parks finally grew.** The four older parks grew revenue 15% — **7% more visitors, 8% higher spend each**. Hyderabad +11%, Bengaluru +6%, Kochi +6%, Bhubaneswar +4%: the best like-for-like footfall in three years, and it matters more than the headline.
- **Spend per visitor does the heavy lifting.** Ticket price ₹1,310 (up only **2%**), non-ticket spend ₹591 (up **20%**), revenue per visitor ₹1,901 (up 7%). Wonderla is barely raising ticket prices and instead selling more food, retail and resort nights to the same person.
- **The extra ₹34.5 cr of EBITDA** (management's own bridge): Chennai +₹21.9 cr, existing parks +₹15.9 cr, resorts +₹3.2 cr, less ₹6.5 cr more head-office cost — so **Chennai supplied 63% of the profit growth**.
- **Chennai is already at mature-park margin, but management will not call it permanent.** Arun Chittilappilly: "For now, it is... it's one of the fastest ramp-ups that we've had... the highs tend to be higher and the lows tend to be lower in a new park." He ruled out 1 million visitors in year one, and conceded the weather helped: "I think there was less rain this year... May, luckily, we didn't have any unseasonal rains."
- **Still no sixth park announced — 20 months after raising ₹540 cr to build one.** Management is "in advanced talks with at least 3 or 4 state governments" and now commits to "before the end of this financial year, we will have something to announce." Capex this year is only ₹35–40 cr of maintenance. Payback promised on a large park: 6–8 years; on a small one, 4–5 years.

2c Business mix & capacity

Revenue split — disclosed per visitor, not in rupees. Wonderla reports **one** segment (amusement parks), with resorts and other income unallocated. It does **not** split ticket vs food-and-beverage vs retail in rupees, and refuses resort profitability (CFO, Aug 2026: "We don't give EBITDA for our resort business"). What it gives every quarter is spend per visitor: Q1 FY27 **ticket ₹1,310 = 69%, non-ticket ₹591 = 31%**. Non-ticket is F&B ("the dominant contributor"), retail and resort stays. Ambition: 40% non-ticket "near term", 50:50 "in the next 4, 5 years" — it has gone 28% (Q1 FY26) to 31%.

Park-wise footfall — fully disclosed. Q1 FY27: Bengaluru 3.43 lakh, Hyderabad 2.90 lakh, Kochi 2.50 lakh, Chennai 2.42 lakh, Bhubaneswar 1.00 lakh; total 12.25 lakh. Full-year FY26 was 32.19 lakh (FY25: 30.49 lakh). Resorts: 123 rooms, all at Bengaluru (84 original + 39 in "Isle by Wonderla", built for ₹39 cr, opened mid-2025), at 60–70% occupancy.

Capacity — the one genuinely encouraging fact here. Management states a large park handles **1.2–1.3 million visitors a year "as-is"** and the small Bhubaneswar format **5–5.5 lakh**: four large plus one small is roughly **55 lakh of installed capacity** against FY26 actual of 32.19 lakh. **Wonderla runs at roughly 60% of the capacity it has already paid for.** Filling the rest needs almost no new capital and would fix the return on capital without a single new park. Spare land too: 250–300 acres at the mature parks, 30–40% undeveloped at Kochi and Bengaluru, and only ~30 of Chennai's 61.87 acres built on.

3 Earning-trigger thesis

Is there a durable earning trigger? Yes — and it has a name: Chennai.

Wonderla spent **₹611 cr** and 21 months building its fifth and largest park at Chennai, opened it on 2 December 2025, and in its first summer the park did **₹45 cr of revenue, 2.42 lakh visitors and ₹21.9 cr of operating profit — a mature-park margin in quarter one**. Management calls it "one of the fastest ramp-ups that we've had." FY27 is Chennai's first full year, so the trigger is not a hope: it is in the reported numbers and repeats for three more quarters. Behind it sits a quieter second trigger — the company runs at roughly **60% of the visitor capacity it has already built**, so the next few years of footfall growth need very little new money. Two things must then be said flatly. First, this is **one park, not a new business model**: strip Chennai out and the other four parks grew 15% off a three-year-low base. Second, the arithmetic is modest. Our calculation, not management's: if Chennai earns ₹45–55 cr of operating profit in a full year (across FY24–FY26 the June quarter was 47–62% of the whole-year figure) and carries ₹45–50 cr of its own depreciation, **its first-year profit before tax on ₹611 cr of capital is close to zero**. Even at full maturity — 1.2 m visitors at today's ₹1,900 spend, 45% margin — a perfect Chennai returns about **9–10% before tax**, roughly 7% after. **That is why ROCE is 6.20%: Wonderla executes well and builds assets that, at their very best, barely beat the cost of the money.**

Trigger	What management said	Evidence so far	Time horizon	Strength
Chennai's first full year	"By the fourth year, it should be able to reach the potential of one of our larger parks like Bangalore" (Feb 2026); margin "in line with other margins as it progresses" (Aug 2026).	Delivered early: launch-month margin 11% (Dec 2025) → ~48% in Q1 FY27, ₹45 cr revenue and 63% of the company's profit growth in one quarter. On track for 7–8 lakh visitors in year one.	Already visible; full effect through FY27	Strong
Spend per visitor (premiumisation)	Non-ticket revenue to 40% "near term", 50:50 "in the next 4, 5 years" (May 2026); ARPU compounding at 8% for four years.	The one promise consistently kept: non-ticket spend/visitor ₹493 → ₹591 (+20%), share 28% → 31%. But the COO warns "we are now at a high base, so we cannot expect similar growth."	Continuous	Strong
Filling existing capacity	Large park takes 1.2–1.3 m visitors "as-is", small park 5–5.5 lakh (Aug 2026); mature parks "low-single-digit footfall" growth.	FY26 footfall 32.19 lakh against ~55 lakh of built capacity. Q1 FY27 like-for-like footfall +7%, best in three years; Hyderabad +11% after two years of decline. Needs almost no capital.	3–5 years	Medium
Margin recovery to 40–45%	"Once we stabilize, maybe some 40% to 45% of EBITDA margin will be expected" (May 2025); "it will settle down in the next financial year" (May 2026).	Not yet. FY26 margin 31–32%; Q1 FY27 margin 46%, exactly the same as Q1 FY26 — Chennai's mature margin was cancelled by ₹6.5 cr of new head-office cost.	FY28 at the earliest	Medium
Sixth park / deploying the QIP cash	₹540 cr raised Dec 2024 to build parks; "we want to add at least another 5 more" (May 2026); "before the end of this financial year, we will have something to announce" (Aug 2026).	Nothing signed in 20 months. FY27 capex guidance is ₹35–40 cr of maintenance only, and ₹400 cr+ sits in investments earning interest — itself part of why ROCE is 6%.	Unknown	Weak

4 Management consistency scorecard

Period	Promised	What happened	Verdict
Jun 2019 → Feb 2024	Chennai, the original promise: land bought by 2019 (₹104 cr spent), " <i>we may need another Rs.260 crores more for completion</i> " (Jun 2019); " <i>we are expecting to open the Chennai Park by October 1, 2021</i> " (Feb 2020). Then " <i>July, August of '25</i> " (Nov 2023), then " <i>second or third quarter of FY '26</i> " (Feb 2024).	Opened 2 December 2025 — four years and two months after the first promised date — and cost ₹611 cr against the ₹364 cr implied in 2019 , a 68% overrun. Covid explains part of it, not all: the slippage continued through FY23 and FY24. Only the last two guided dates were actually hit.	No
May 2024 Q4 FY24 call	Bhubaneswar park: " <i>internally we are hoping to achieve at least 4 lakh footfalls... at an ARPU of roughly Rs.800–1,000. This is our conservative estimate.</i> "	FY25 Bhubaneswar footfall: 1.69 lakh — 58% below the "conservative" estimate. FY26: about 2 lakh.	No
May 2024	FY25 group guidance: existing-park footfall growth up to 5%, " <i>footfall growth and ARPU growth will be about 10% to 12%</i> ".	FY25 revenue fell 5% to ₹459 cr, footfall fell ~6% to 30.49 lakh, net profit fell from ₹158 cr to ₹109 cr (and even that included a ₹24.1 cr one-off deferred-tax gain).	No
May 2024 & May 2025	Build promises: Bhubaneswar " <i>finished the project in 13-months' time</i> "; Chennai " <i>towards the end of Q3 FY'26</i> ", reaffirmed Aug 2025 as " <i>on schedule to commence operations by December 2025.</i> "	Both delivered. Bhubaneswar soft-launched 24 May 2024 for ~₹190 cr on government-leased land. Chennai opened 2 December 2025 , built in 21 months, final cost ₹611 cr against a ₹610 cr budget, 40+ rides, 10-year local-body tax exemption secured. Hit to the month and to the rupee.	Yes
May 2025	Margin: " <i>once we stabilize, maybe some 40% to 45% of EBITDA margin will be expected. That's what the regular EBITDA margin previously if you consider pre-COVID.</i> "	FY26 full-year margin: 31–32% . Repeated in May 2026 as " <i>it will settle down in the next financial year.</i> " The target has now been rolled forward twice.	Not yet
Aug 2025 Q1 FY26 call	" <i>The margins will be under pressure maybe for another year... Maybe after Q1</i> "	That quarter has arrived. Q1 FY27 operating margin: 46% — identical to Q1 FY26's 46% . Chennai came in at a	No

	<i>of next financial year also, it should improve."</i>	mature margin and ₹6.5 cr of new head-office cost cancelled the gain.	
Aug 2025	Bhubaneswar: <i>"we should cross 3 lakh footfalls this year, and that's what we are working towards."</i>	FY26 actual: <i>"we've been able to get close to 2 lakhs footfall this year"</i> (May 2026). Missed by a third. The FY27 target was then reset downwards to 2.5 lakh.	No
Aug 2025	Non-ticket revenue: <i>"we want to get to a 60%, 40% kind of number eventually"</i> (i.e. 40% of revenue from food, retail, resorts).	28% of revenue per visitor (Q1 FY26) → 31% (Q1 FY27). Slow, but genuinely moving in the promised direction, and non-ticket spend per head rose 20% in the last year.	On track
Dec 2024 → Aug 2026	₹540 cr QIP raised expressly to build new parks; Nov 2025 guidance of <i>"roughly 2 parks every 3 years"</i> ; Feb 2026 <i>"we will definitely sign minimum one, maybe two or three at more locations."</i>	Twenty months on, not one new site has been signed. FY27 capex guidance is ₹35–40 cr of maintenance. The commitment has hardened only into <i>"before the end of this financial year, we will have something to announce"</i> (Aug 2026). ₹400 cr sits in investments.	No
Feb 2026 Q3 FY26 call	Chennai: <i>"over mid to long term, we expect it to give an EBITDA similar to some of our existing large parks like Hyderabad and Bangalore"</i> , i.e. 40–45%, within <i>"4-5 months or maybe in the first year."</i>	Delivered ahead of schedule. Chennai's margin went from 11% in launch month to roughly 48% in Q1 FY27, six months in.	Yes

Narrative drift. Across ten years of calls one pattern dominates: **Wonderla is excellent at pouring concrete and poor at everything upstream and downstream of it.** Once ground is broken it delivers — 13 months for Bhubaneswar, 21 for Chennai, ₹611 cr against a ₹610 cr estimate. But getting to ground-breaking took Chennai six years past its first promised opening date and 68% past its first budget, and the sixth park has not started at all. Downstream, every demand promise was missed, and the misses are always external: an early monsoon, Operation Sindoor, a cyclone, an amoeba scare in Kerala that stopped school trips, a school-bus ban in Telangana, a Gulf war, elections in two states. Each is individually credible; together they describe a team that forecasts as if weather were controllable.

Three story changes are worth naming. **First, the growth engine was quietly swapped.** Until FY24 the story was "add parks and footfall compounds"; by May 2025 the MD conceded *"we're not expecting huge growth in footfalls from our tenured parks... mild growth only"*, and by Nov 2025 the COO reframed growth entirely as premiumisation. One good quarter later the footfall story was back. **Second, the geography strategy reversed openly:** *"initially, we had a plan of doing smaller parks, but then we recalibrated and we felt that we will do Tier 1"* (May 2026). Bhubaneswar was sold as the asset-light Tier-2 template and is now *"like an experiment"* — candid, but it means the QIP was raised against a plan that no longer exists, much of why the money is still uninvested. **Third, the margin promise keeps being re-based on a fresh one-off:** Bhubaneswar launch costs, then Chennai's ₹5.5 cr launch spend, then an ₹8 cr labour-code provision, ₹5 cr of extra marketing, ₹1.5 cr of point-of-sale spend, ₹6.5 cr of head-office build-out. Individually each is a one-off; consecutively, they are the run-rate.

To their credit they do not pretend otherwise when pushed — the MD volunteered the dry-May point and says openly that *"footfall growth is unpredictable by its very nature"* — and the disclosure (park-by-park footfall, ticket price, non-ticket spend, a full EBITDA bridge each quarter) beats most Indian mid-caps. The problem is not candour; it is that capital keeps going into assets whose returns are consistently over-estimated.

5 Bottom line

1. Is there a real earning trigger? — YES, but it is one asset, not a new business.

Chennai is a genuine, funded, already-visible trigger. It opened on time, cost what it was meant to, reached a mature operating margin within six months, and in its first summer supplied 60% of the company's revenue growth and 63% of its profit growth. FY27 is its first full year, so three more quarters of the same effect are essentially booked. Two smaller supports sit alongside: non-ticket spend per visitor rose 20%, and only about 60% of built visitor capacity is in use, so the next stretch of footfall growth is close to free. That is why the June 2026 quarter was the best on record and why FY27 revenue should comfortably beat FY26's ₹519 cr. What it is **not** is a change in the economics. Strip Chennai out and the four older parks grew 15% off the weakest June quarter in three years, helped by a dry May management itself acknowledged. And the plainest fact in this report: FY26 footfall was 32.19 lakh from five parks against **32.5 lakh from just three parks in FY24** — roughly ₹800 cr of new parks, the same number of people through the gates.

2. Has management been consistent? — HALF. They deliver every building and miss every forecast — and a 6.20% return on capital is the bill for that.

On construction the record deserves saying without hedging: two parks built in 13 and 21 months from ground-breaking, on schedule and on budget, in-house-designed rides at a fraction of imported cost, no debt and ₹400 cr of spare cash. On everything else it is the opposite. Chennai was first promised for October 2021 and opened in December 2025 at ₹611 cr against a ₹364 cr plan. Bhubaneswar was promised 4 lakh visitors and did 1.69 lakh, then promised 3 lakh and did 2 lakh; FY25 was guided to grow and shrank 5%; the 40–45% margin, promised since May 2025 and rolled forward twice, was due this quarter and came in

flat year-on-year. And ₹540 cr raised in December 2024 to build parks has, twenty months on, bought nothing. All of it lands in one number: ROCE of 6.20%. Plainly: ₹1,800 cr of shareholder money sits in land, rides and buildings and earns about ₹110 cr a year before tax — less than a fixed deposit, from a business carrying weather risk, safety risk and a loss-making September quarter. The section-3 trigger should lift that to perhaps 8–9% by FY28, but on management's own payback numbers even a flawless new park tops out near 9–10% pre-tax. Until the empty 40% of capacity is filled, more parks will not fix the return — and this team knows how to build them but has never shown it can forecast who turns up.